

VIDEO ART

Concept, direction, performance, and edit
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STILL

A single-channel video art piece on the cycle that resists every attempt to break it

MSJ2202: Convergence Communication II
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Portfolio note

STILL is a solo video art piece I made for an open brief in Convergence Communication II — the assignment set no subject, only the form. I wrote, directed, performed in, and edited it. This document is the artist's statement and a short formal analysis of the work; the film itself is linked below and is the primary artefact. The writing here is my own reading of what I built and why.

► WATCH THE FILM

STILL — a short video art piece (single-channel video). [Youtube](#)

Artist's Statement

I wanted to make something about the kind of stuckness that does not look dramatic from the outside. Not a crisis — a loop. The feeling of waking up, deciding today will be different, doing the things you think are supposed to change your life, and ending the day exactly where you began, then doing it again. STILL is about that. The title is a pun I could not resist: still as in motionless, and still as in yet again, the word you say when nothing has moved.

The brief gave us full creative freedom, which is harder than it sounds. With no subject handed to you, you find out what you actually want to say. What I kept returning to was repetition — so I built the piece around return rather than progression. There is no story in the conventional sense, no arc that resolves. The character tries; the frame brings him back. I was less interested in telling a plot than in making the viewer feel the shape of a day that eats its own effort.

I will be honest about the limits. This is a student piece, shot with what I had, and some of the choices were as much constraint as intention. But the central decision — to refuse forward motion, to make the structure itself the argument — was deliberate, and it is the thing I would defend.

The Work

STILL opens close on a face beside a digital clock. The clock is the first thing that tells you what kind of film this is: time is present, counted, insisted upon, but it does not seem to lead anywhere. From there the piece cycles through a small set of images — the character writing the word STILL into a notebook, hard enough that the writing reads as frustration rather than note-taking; a stairwell; a computer showing a “No internet” screen; a dartboard; and the bed again, before the image falls to black.

None of these images is doing what it conventionally does. A stairwell normally signals transition — you climb it to get somewhere. Here it leads back into the loop, so the symbol of movement becomes another station in a circuit. The dartboard is an image of aim, of trying to hit a mark, but in a film about stasis it reads as the futility of aiming when nothing in the environment will move. The “No internet” screen is the most contemporary of the motifs, and the one I am fondest of: it is the small modern death of a plan, the moment the day’s intended escape route simply fails to load. The fade to black at the end is not a resolution. It is the same darkness the character woke into, which means the film could begin again from its last frame.

Image	What it does in the film
Face + clock	Opens the film. Time is counted and ever-present but goes nowhere — the loop’s metronome.
Writing “STILL”	The character names his own condition. The pressure of the pen reads as frustration, not record-keeping.
Stairwell	Borrows the conventional symbol of transition and empties it — the stairs lead back into the cycle.
“No internet” screen	The modern small failure: the planned escape route does not load. The most contemporary motif.
Dartboard	Aim and target in a film about stasis — the futility of trying to hit a mark in an unmoving world.
Bed + fade to black	Return to the start. The ending is the beginning, so the film could loop from its final frame.

Form as Argument

The thesis of the piece is carried by its structure, not by anything spoken. I made the editing circular on purpose: the sequence returns to where it started, so the form performs the meaning rather than describing it. A film about a cycle that told a forward-moving story would be lying about its own subject. The decision let the rhythm of return do the work that a narrative would normally do.

Repetition is the central device. In moving-image work, a motif that recurs accrues meaning each time it returns; by the third appearance of the bed, the viewer is not seeing a bed but feeling a sentence repeat. This is closer to how a refrain works in music than to how an event works in a plot. I leaned on that. The close framing throughout keeps the world small and airless — there is little establishing space, few wide shots that would let the viewer breathe or orient, which is the claustrophobia of the loop made visual. The clock recurs as the only marker of passing time, and its presence is almost mocking: time passes, the film insists, and still nothing changes.

If I were to push the piece further, I would tighten the pacing and be more disciplined about the sound, which is where a mood film like this lives or dies. But the architecture is sound. The film knows what it is about, and it refuses to cheat its way.

A Note on Process

After I finished the edit, I ran the piece past a generative AI model and asked it, cold, to tell me what it thought the film was about — a way of testing whether my intended meaning actually came through to a viewer with no context. It read the loop, the stairwell-that-leads-nowhere, the return to the bed, and named the theme as a cycle the character cannot escape. That was useful confirmation that the structure was legible without explanation. The reading in this statement, though, is my own; the AI check told me the film communicated, not what to think about it. I mention this because the relationship between my creative work and AI tools is something I think about seriously as a media researcher, and I would rather be transparent about where a tool entered the process than pretend it did not.